9.4. Working with query string

A query string plays a pivotal role in making web applications. A cookie file is completely dependent on the client when the complete function depends on frequent accessibility of users. When a form is submitted using the GET method, the fields and values are encoded with a URL and the filled form is sent. A form with two fields including user_id and name ends up like, http://www.oursite.co.in/qstring.php?name=abcd&user_id=xyz+pqr.

Here, every name and value is divided by an equal (=) operator. The names and value pair are separated by an ampersand sign (&). In PHP, the strings are decoded and pairs are available in the $HTTP_GET_VARS array. You access the user_id using the GET parameter. You can use the GET array as:

```
$HTTP_GET_VARS[user_id];
```

Creating a query string:

A query string can be created with a URL for encoding the keys and values. Suppose you have to pass a URL to another page as a query string, then a forward slash and the colon sign appear ambiguous to the parser. Therefore, convert the URL into hexadecimal characters. To do this, use PHP's urlencode() function. This accepts a string as an argument and returns an encoded copy such as `print urlencode(http://www.oursite.co.in);`

```
// prints http%3A%2F%2Fwww. oursite.co.in
```

Look at the example on query string made from two variables:
Example:

```
<?php
$name = "john";
$ourpage = "http://www.oursite.co.in";
$query_string = "ourpage=".urlencode( $ourpage );
$query_string .= "&name=".urlencode( $name );
?>
<a href="ourpage.php?<?php echo $query_string
?>">Go</a>
```

To dynamically make a query string, use the http_build_query () function.

Function to create string:

```
<html>
```